

EDITORIAL WORKSHOP - SESSION 1

LEVELS OF EDITING

- ❖ Developmental Editing
- ❖ Copyediting
 - Line-editing
 - Fact-checking
- ❖ Proofreading
- ❖ Spot-Checking
- ❖ Beta-reading

- **Developmental Editing/ Substantive Editing**

Involves detailed feedback and collaboration with the author on macro level issues in the manuscript. Focus on big-picture factors like plot coherence, compelling character arcs, powerful climax, chapter wise transitions and thematic considerations.

- **Factors to keep in mind during developmental editing**

- What is the thematic statement of the story?
 - Thematic statement the “central” or “controlling story idea,” the idea that guides you in writing your entire novel. It shapes the strategic choices you make as you write.
 - If used skillfully, a thematic statement will make the story feel deeper, and touch readers on an emotional level. It may even change how they view the world and how they behave.
 - Are the characters and settings complementing the genre of the book?
 - Are the sequence of events in the story logically coherent?
 - Does the actions of the characters align with their personality?
 - Is the conflict and resolution compelling enough?
 - Does the story have a balance of description and character conversations?
 - Are the transitions between chapters and scenes smooth or abrupt?

- **Copy-editing and Line editing**

Involves a closer look at the manuscript to ensure that the writing is more engaging and reader-friendly. We need to improve the clarity, coherency, consistency, and correctness of the language and address word-repetition. Broadly, we need to engage with the technicalities here and fix mechanical issues.

Fact-Checking is an intrinsic part of copy-editing. Since the editor is working on a simpler software, it is easier to rectify factual errors. For fiction, fact-checking will involve checking word usage and their meanings, idioms and spellings.

- **Factors to keep in mind while copy-editing**

- Spellings and typos
- Grammatical inconsistencies
- Capitalization issues.
- Avoid repetition of words
- Usage of numbers or numerals
- Tense inconsistencies
- Character names inconsistencies

- **Proofreading**

In this stage, the editor needs to take the reader's perspective in mind. The editor will primarily be working on the designed file so you should keep an eye out on stylistic issues which can visually enhance the reading experience.

- **Factors to keep in mind while proofreading:**

- Inconsistencies in layout and typography;
- Punctuation errors and the overuse of commas and semicolon
- Confusing page and word breaks;
- Incorrect captioning on any illustrations and page numbers in the contents.
- Spacing issues between words and lines
- Bold and Italics convention
 - Anything that looks visually awkward needs to be flagged.
- Lingering typos and technical errors.

- **Coordination with the typesetter**

- A proofreader is supposed to communicate with the typesetter as you will be editing the designed layout. A typesetter designs the

book so he/she is majorly technical in their approach. The instructions have to be short, clear and crisp. It should be phrased as a command and not as a suggestion.

- Incorrect Instruction: The word can be in italics
- Correct Instruction: Change the word in italics
- TOOLS IN ADOBE PDF
- **Spot-Checking**
 - To be Conducted by Chief Editor/ Editor in Chief
- **Beta-reading**
 - The manuscript is shared with our target audience a.k.a a potential reader.

THE THREE C's- MANTRA OF EFFECTIVE EDITING

- ❖ **CONSISTENCY**
 - The tone, character spellings, bold/italics formatting, spelling convention (US/UK English usage) have to be consistent everywhere.
- ❖ **CONCISE WRITING**
 - Avoid long-winding and convoluted construction. Make the writing simple and elegant.
- ❖ **CLARITY OF MEANING**
 - Weed out phrases and sentences which are vague and do not add anything to the plot or character evolution.

EDITING STYLESHEET

- **ORTHOGRAPHY**

- Ideally follow British orthography, albeit with ‘z’ in words like civilize, organize, etc. But if you are following American orthography in some cases, that works too. Keep the orthography consistent throughout the book.

- **NUMBER:**

- From one to hundred, these should be in words, and thereafter in numerals.
- Years and dates are always in numeral, as in 15 January 1999 (the date precedes the month; no comma after the month); similarly for a date without the year, e.g. 1 March.
- For fractions that are spelt out, print three-quarters/ two-thirds.
- Use the symbol % for a percentage; no space between numeral and symbol – 35%; in humanistic copy, the word percent should be used (one word)
- No apostrophe between the year and the ‘s’: 1990s.
- A single open close quote to highlight dates written thus: 90s’

CAPITALS

- Designations are capitalised when the designation is used as a prefix to the name. E.g. Prime Minister Narendra Modi, but in lower case otherwise, as in the Indian prime minister. Similarly, for ministries and organisations, capitals are used when the full title is used, as in Ministry of Education, but not when it is education ministry.
- Specific terms like the Indian Army, Indian Air Force or Indian Navy are capitalised, but the words army, navy, etc., are lower case when standing alone or not part of an official title.
- Partition is capitalised when referring to it as a noun, as in at the time of Partition; but not when used as a verb, as in the partition of India. Likewise with ‘independence’.
- The Second World War, First World War, etc., would be capitalised.

- a.m. (ante meridiem), p.m. (post meridiem), should be in lower case, except in lines of capitals or small capitals.
- Acronyms should always be explained in brackets in the first instance, as in All India Radio (AIR), and only the acronym used in subsequent references.

FULL POINT

- Use periods in the case of initials, as in J.P. Singh.
- Abbreviations and contractions consisting of upper and lower cases take full points as in Mt. (Mount) St. (Saint) Ph.D (Doctor 'of Philosophy), exceptions to be made for Rs, Dr (Doctor) Revd (Reverend: not Rev), Mr, Mrs, Mme, Mlle (Mademoiselle), Prof, Col - here full points are not required.

ITALICS

- Common/generic Indian words – masala, dhoti, kurta, salaam, ghazal, bhangra, bharatnatyam, kathak, ji, dada, mama, chacha – may be excluded from italicisation.
- For uncommon non-English words, italicise in the *first instance only* to designate it as a non-English word, but keep in roman henceforth.
- Use of italics should be kept to the minimum. Names of books and journals must be italicised (not in quotes) but not the titles of articles, poems, Ph.D theses and unpublished material.
- Titles of plays, films and TV serials should be in italics.
- etc. is always in roman typeface with a full point.
- et al. is always in italics. Other non-English words, as in French, Latin etc. will be italicised.
- Names of specific ships, aircrafts, etc., are italicised, but not abbreviations preceding them, e.g. HMS *Mayflower*.

CONNECTING PHRASES

- In works of fiction, keep the use of conjunctions like ‘and’, ‘but’, ‘thus’, ‘hence’, ‘since’, etc., to the minimum. Wherever possible, make the sentence complete without using these terms, or else join by N- dashes, or break the sentence.
- However, it may be the author’s style to use conjunctions, in which case coordinate and work out a style with the author.
- In some cases, however, two or more commas are necessary:
 - The French, having occupied Portugal, began to advance into Spain.
 - Be assured, then, that order, frugality, and economy are the necessary supporters of every personal and private virtue.

DIALOGUE WRITING PUNCTUATION RULES

I

- Comma before the opening quotation mark.
- Capital letter to indicate the beginning of a sentence inside the opening quotation mark.
- Period to end the quoted sentence.
- Closing quotation mark.
 - Example: Mary said, “Call me tomorrow.”
 - “Call me tomorrow,” Mary said.

II

- Capital letter to indicate the beginning of a sentence inside the opening quotation mark.
- A comma to end the quoted sentence before the closing quotation mark that precedes the dialogue tag.
- Dialogue tag at the end with a period to end the sentence.
 - Example: “Call me,” Mary said, “tomorrow.”

III

- If some expression does not hint at the dialogue having been said out loud, it need not be preceded or followed by a comma.
 - “I knew you won’t be able to make it.” He smirked/ smiled/ laughed/ clicked his fingers/ turned around/ cheered.

IV

- If a character is quoting someone else in their speech, you need to place this within quote marks as well. But to prevent confusion, you should use the opposite kind of quote marks as you use for the main quotation.
 - For instance, if we were using single quotation marks for our main quote, we would use double quote marks for the quote-within-a-quote:
 - ‘He called me an “arrogant fool” when I said I’d seen bigger horses.’
 - Here, we use double quote marks around ‘arrogant fool’. This shows that the speaker is quoting someone else within their dialogue.

V

- A good guideline when formatting dialogue is ‘new speaker, new paragraph’. This means that when someone new starts speaking, you set the dialogue on a new line.
 - For instance: Craig stared at the massive horse. ‘So huge,’ he muttered to himself.

‘What are you doing?’ asked Shannon, emerging from the farmhouse.

‘I’m watching this massive horse,’ Craig said.

‘Well, I can see that,’ Shannon said. ‘But you’ve been here for six hours, Craig.’

VI

- One passage of dialogue may require multiple paragraphs.
 - For instance, a character may be telling another character a story within a story as part of your narrative, which could involve speaking at length.
 - Use a quotation mark at the start of each paragraph when formatting dialogue. However, you will only use a closing quotation mark when the character finally finishes speaking.
 - Example: Craig sighed. ‘I’ve always been obsessed with horses,’ he explained. ‘When I was a child, I spent weekends on my grandparents’ farm. But all they had were miniature ponies. And they told me that all

horses were the same size. They said the ones I saw on television looked bigger because they hired tiny actors to ride them. And I believed it.

‘Or, I did until I was eighteen, anyway. That’s when I met Clayton Moore, the guy who played the Lone Ranger on TV. And he was over six feet tall, so I knew that Silver couldn’t have been as small as the ponies on my grandparents’ farm! It had all been a lie! I felt so betrayed. And ever since then, I have been looking for the biggest horse I can find.’

VII

- Use ellipses to show that speech has trailed off.
 - Example: ‘I don’t know why you have a problem with...’ Craig said, before falling into silence.

VIII

- Use capitalization to indicate the end of the sentence.
 - When writing dialogue, only capitalize the first letter of a word to indicate the end of the sentence.
 - When using quotations, though, capitalization in mid-sentence is common. More specifically, when quotations form complete sentences, they must be capitalized no matter where they appear in the main sentence. All of the sentences below are correct, for example:

Matthew said, “In that case, I’m going out for a walk!”

“We are not amused.” – Queen Victoria

Neil Young’s admonishment “It’s better to burn out than it is to rust” is not appreciated by everyone.

- There may be times when you end the quote with punctuation that would normally require the next word to be capitalized, such as an exclamation point or question mark. But unless the sentence is truly over, use a lowercase letter to follow this punctuation.

- Example: "He's here! He's here!" she screamed.

"Would you like to answer the door?" she asked.

"What do you mean," he said to Jenna, "by asking me to dinner?"